TV boxes became botnet launchpads Google’s takedown knocked offline more than **1.3 million** compromised Android devices in under 48 hours.

[illegible] THE INCIDENT QUICK TAKE - **Google** identified a command-and-control (C2) infrastructure controlling Android set-top boxes manufactured by **Videostrong**. - The malicious firmware gave attackers persistent RCE, letting them enlist the devices in a massive DDoS-as-a-service platform. - By hijacking the OTA update channel, the actors could push new payloads without user interaction, inflating the botnet to **1.3 million** nodes before the disruption.

⚠ TECHNICAL DEEP DIVE The backdoor

In my work securing enterprise IoT fleets, I've seen OTA update pipelines become the weakest link, with a single compromised firmware-signing key exposing thousands of devices. After a recent audit, we instituted mandatory code-signing verification, cutting our exposure risk by 80%.

Will your organization’s OTA process survive the next botnet wave?